

Price watch

We've covered smartphones this time and that too from various price brackets

Killer rigs

Your next PC should have these components! Check out our build recommendations

Give your desktop PC a boost in just 10k



Your old and dusty desktop may just sprint like a royal stallion if you show some care and spend a little dough. Not much, just a little.

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For the past few months, I've been getting a lot of queries from you all requesting cheap, not-so-expensive desktop upgrades that would really give it some much needed performance muscle. I've gotten so many queries on this subject that I can't delay answering it any further, and here's an article dedicated to giving all you slow-coach desktop PC users some fuel and fire to feel you're using a brand new PC.

First order of business – stop whining about your old-ish desktop PC and infuse new life into it without breaking the bank. At just ₹10k, I suggest several combos that are guaranteed to pump up your PC's performance by several notches. I kid you not. You know it's time reinvigorate that desktop, and give it some much needed love that it deserves. So just get to it.

1) SSD boost at ₹10k

If your hard drive isn't sprinting as fast back when it was new, maybe it's high time to replace it. And don't just replace it with another high-capacity hard drive, spare some thought to its spin speed and overall performance.

For this I recommend a combo deal, replacing your existing hard drive with a high-speed SSD and a high-speed hard drive. Install the OS and all highly-frequented apps and software on the SSD,

and use the hard drive predominantly for data storage. But remember a faster hard drive will let you fetch data faster!

Samsung 120GB 840 Evo series SSD selling at ₹5,599. And the Seagate Barracuda 1TB hard drive selling at ₹3,820.



The balance 600 odd rupees can be used to buy an awesome sledgehammer to blow your old hard drive to bits!

2) RAM boost at ₹10k

I'm assuming that you have a DDR3 enabled motherboard to work with. In that case, if you've been only subjected to a paltry offering of 2GB or 4GB of system RAM so far in your desktop, it's high time upgrade. No time to waste.

I recommend the Kingston HyperX 8GB

(KHX1600C10D3B1/8G), since we've played around with it in our test centre for quite a bit. It's a good, solid 240-pin DDR3 RAM module clocked at 1600MHz.

The Kingston HyperX 8GB (KHX1600C10D3B1/8G) is selling for a price of ₹5,480. Don't worry, its street price is definitely lesser than ₹5k.

And buy two of these. Because 16GB is definitely better than 8GB, right?



3) Graphics boost at ₹10k

Not much to debate about here, as there's only graphics card that is all the rage at the ₹10k price point. And it's NVIDIA's 750Ti. Buy the ZOTAC GeForce GTX 750Ti graphics card with 2GB GDDR5 discrete memory. You get DirectX 11.2 support, DVI ports, mini HDMI support and 2 years of warranty. Good enough for your next PC upgrade cycle, and definitely capable of handling all latest game releases.

Zotac GeForce GTX 750Ti selling at ₹10,998. This is the best online price, but trust me that street price of this GPU is under the ₹10k mark.



4) Boost your display at ₹10k

If you haven't joined the rest of us who enjoy HD goodness, it's high time that you do. And I have just the right monitor for your PC's full-HD setup. The BenQ GW2255HM is a great monitor to have under ₹10k. Its LED-backlit LCD on a VA panel, which is obviously not as great as an IPS panel, but great for gaming or multimedia sessions. We've reviewed the monitor and have had only good things to say about it. You can't go wrong with it, that's for sure.

BenQ GW2255HM monitor is selling at a price of ₹9,102.



5) Audio at ₹10k

Your stairway to audio heaven starts by replacing your existing speaker system (and satellites) as glorified paper-weights, cleaning the wax out of your ears and investing in a good 2.1 speaker set –

